

Six-Day War between Israel and Arab forces from Egypt, Syria, and Jordan. The Oslo Accords met one key goal of Resolution 242; the PLO recognized Israel's right to exist and was acknowledged in turn as Palestine's representative body. They also afforded the Palestinians a degree of self-governance in the occupied territories of Gaza and the West Bank and required both sides not to incite violence against each other. The 5-year interim period set out in the Accords ended in 1999 without agreement, violence resurfaced, and the provisions of the Accords were largely abandoned.

See also: The Peace of Westphalia 94–95 ■ The Treaty of Versailles 192–193

THE UNDERLYING LAW ACT 2000

Until 1975, when Papua New Guinea became independent from Britain, the Papuan legal system had been based on English common law. The new Papuan constitution embraced both customary law and common law. The Act seeks to ensure that customary law is a key source of the nation's underlying law and is applied unless it is inconsistent with a written law or contrary to national interests and goals.

See also: The St. Catherine's Milling case 169

THE USA PATRIOT ACT 2001

A month after the deadliest terrorist attacks in US history, carried out on September 11, 2001, by the Islamic extremist group al-Qaeda, President George W. Bush signed into law the USA PATRIOT Act (an acronym for

Uniting and Strengthening America by Providing Appropriate Tools Required to Intercept and Obstruct Terrorism). The Act expanded the surveillance powers of intelligence and law enforcement agencies, among other measures facilitating searches of suspect individuals' homes, business premises, emails, telephone, and financial records—powers which have repeatedly raised civil rights concerns. From 2005, 16 sections of the Act were due to “sunset” (cease to have effect), but a modified Act passed in 2006 made 14 of the sunset provisions permanent and extended two others. In 2011, three major surveillance measures were extended until 2015. The USA FREEDOM Act of 2015 limited the US government's authority to collect data, but key surveillance powers of the USA PATRIOT Act were again restored and extended.

See also: The International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights 256–257

THE WORLD PRESS FREEDOM INDEX 2002

In a bid to counter the suppression of information, every year since 2002, Reporters Without Borders (RSF) has published the World Press Freedom Index, which ranks 180 countries according to the level of freedom afforded to journalists. RSF pools responses from experts and analyzes abuses and acts of violence against journalists to determine the rankings. Norway topped the 2020 index for the fourth year in a row, while North Korea replaced Turkmenistan in last place.

See also: The Universal Declaration of Human Rights 222–229

THE INFECTIOUS DISEASE CONTROL AND PREVENTION ACT 2009

When the COVID-19 pandemic struck in 2020, South Korea could quickly take steps to combat the virus thanks to earlier legislation covering infectious diseases. As well as extensive testing, its government employed a measure added to the Act in 2015, when the country faced an outbreak of MERS-CoV, a similar coronavirus. The amendment allowed officials to collect cellphones, emails, and other data revealing the movements of infectious patients in the period before they were diagnosed. This was then published on social media to alert, trace, and test possible contacts. While judged intrusive by some, the measure helped South Korea to contain infection levels.

See also: The International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights 256–257

THE MODERN SLAVERY ACT 2015

Under the UK Act, which enhances earlier legislation and reparations for victims, any organization that supplies goods or services in the UK and has a global turnover of more than £36 million must publish an annual statement outlining the measures it takes to ensure that no human trafficking, slavery, or forced labor occur in any part of its operations. A 2019 Home Office review has called for the Act to be further strengthened and extended to cover the public sector.

See also: The Abolition of the Slave Trade Act 132–139